Choose the Date and Time format for your cells

time will be displayed in the 24-hour or AM/PM format. Internally, however, Excel automatically stores any date and time value in a serial number that is calculated based on January 1, 1900 being equal to the number 1, and every subsequent date being an increment of 1 from that date. That is, Excel will internally store January 2, 1900 as 2, February 2, 1900 as 33, and so on. Similarly, time is stored as a decimal fraction starting from midnight equal to 0.00000000, and, say, 6:33 AM equal to 0.27291700—and so on.

To work with date and time values, you would normally format the cells where the data is being entered. That is, if you wish to display the date and time in dd/mm/yyyy format and time in 12-hour format, you would select the cell, right-click, and select Format Cells, then use the Date and Time sections in the Number tab to select from pre-defined date and time formats. Or, you may use the Custom section to specify any non-standard date and time formats.

Excel normally displays the date and time based on the regional settings of the computer you are working on. This will be the default display for date and time. On most computers, the default date setting is usually in the American format mm/dd/yyyy, where the display will show month first followed by day and year. The Indian format is, of course, to have the date first followed by month and year i.e. dd/mm/yyyy. You can change the default display to this format by changing the Regional Settings in the Control Panel.